

What I Learned From the Sony Hack

REVIEW





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WSJ. MAGAZINE

What's News

Business & Finance

◆ U.S. economic growth slowed sharply at the end of last year, weighed down by a record-long government shutdown and cooler consumer spending. **A1**

◆ Key inflation metrics tracked by the Fed accelerated at the end of 2025. **A2**

◆ Americans' assessment of the economy improved slightly in February, according to the University of Michigan's monthly survey, yet high prices continued to keep many on edge. **A2**

◆ U.S. stock indexes rose after the Supreme Court rejected Trump's tariffs. The S&P, Dow and Nasdaq gained 1.1%, 0.3% and 1.5%, respectively, for the week. **B10**

◆ Google is exploring new ways to expand the market for its AI chips, seeking to use its financial might to build a broader AI ecosystem. **B9**

◆ Microsoft's executive vice president and chief executive of gaming, Phil Spencer, is set to retire from the company after 38 years. **B9**

◆ Danone projected steady sales growth and expects a muted impact from infant-formula recalls. **B10**

◆ Boaz Weinstein's Saba Capital and Cox Capital plan a tender offer for stakes in three Blue Owl Capital private-credit funds. **B10**

Worldwide

◆ President Trump's global tariffs are illegal, the Supreme Court ruled Friday, in a stinging repudiation of a signature White House initiative. **A1, A4-5**

◆ Trump's pivot on tariffs puts his trade agenda on a collision course with the midterm campaign season. **A1**

◆ The last group of striking New York City nurses have reached a tentative agreement, potentially ending the largest and longest nursing strike in city history. **A3**

◆ U.S. intelligence agencies have concluded that 15,000 to 20,000 people, including Islamic State affiliates, are at large in Syria, after an exodus from a camp that held jihadists' families. **A7**

◆ Fifteen migrants the U.S. deported to Cameroon in recent weeks are being held in prisonlike conditions at a secret detention facility, according to lawyers for some of the deportees. **A7**

◆ Trump is at a crossroads: He could sign a deal that curbs Iran's nuclear program, or launch a war with hard-to-control consequences. **A7**

◆ An amnesty law approved by Venezuela came under criticism amid concerns that it would leave many political prisoners jailed. **A9**

◆ The Trump administration has plans for a potential re-opening of the U.S. Embassy in Damascus, Syria. **A9**

PEGGY NOONAN

Rubio plays good cop to Vance's bad **A13**

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Court Rejects Trump's Tariffs



President Trump, with Commerce Secretary Howard Lutnick looking on, said Friday he 'was ashamed of certain members' of the Supreme Court after it struck down his tariff plan. He said he would push ahead with tariffs based on other legal authorities.

President's Altered Trade Plan Collides With Midterm Politics

By GAVIN BADE

President Trump's pivot on tariffs puts his trade agenda on a collision course with the midterm campaign season. Just hours after his main tariff rationale was invalidated by the Supreme Court on Friday, Trump said he would implement new levies under two separate legal authorities—one short term, another longer lasting. Some of the new tariffs Trump wants to impose re-

quire congressional approval to extend beyond five months. Others require months of investigations before they can be put into place. In both cases, that pushes key tariff decisions into the summer, just months before November's midterms when many Republicans are likely to be especially sensitive to complaints about inflation and affordability. In a sign of growing anxiety toward his tariffs, six GOP lawmakers voted with Demo-

crats in an attempt to rein in Trump's tariff powers in the House of Representatives recently. The Senate passed three similar resolutions last year on narrow bipartisan votes. Now, Republicans running for re-election will have to grapple with tariff drama along with other attacks from Democrats on the economy. "The potential that they could be asked by the White House to vote to levy higher tariffs on their constituents is not something Congress would

look forward to," said former Rep. Kevin Brady (R., Texas), who led the Ways and Means Committee during Trump's first term. "The conventional wisdom is that there isn't support for that." On Friday, House Speaker Mike Johnson (R., La.), who has defended the president's *Please turn to page A5*

◆ How tariffs changed the year in trade..... **A4**

◆ Ruling sets off a scramble for refunds..... **A5**

The 6-3 decision finds president exceeded powers; Trump orders new global 10% levy

By JAMES ROMOSER AND GAVIN BADE

WASHINGTON—President Trump's global tariffs are illegal, the Supreme Court ruled Friday, in a stinging repudiation of a signature White House initiative. The 6-3 decision, written by Chief Justice John Roberts, removes a diplomatic tool Trump has wielded to remake U.S. trade deals and collect tens of billions of dollars from companies importing foreign goods. The ruling didn't address if the government will have to pay back the tariff revenue it has collected. The court's silence on the issue created a scramble as companies looked to assert their rights, while Trump warned he had no plans to retreat. On Friday night, he said he signed an order to impose a new global 10% tariff, based on other legal authorities. "We're going forward," Trump said. "We'll be able to take in more money." It is the first time the Supreme Court has definitively struck down one of Trump's second-term policies. In other areas, the court has granted Trump latitude to deploy executive power in novel ways, but a majority of the justices—three conservatives and three liberals—said he went too far in enacting his most sweeping tariffs without clear authorization from Congress. The court rejected Trump's argument that a 1977 law, the International Emergency Economic Powers Act, implicitly authorized the tariffs. "Had Congress intended to convey the distinct and extraordinary power to impose tariffs, it would have done so expressly," Roberts wrote. *Please turn to page A4*

Envoy Role, Not Sex, Tripped Up Ex-Prince With Police

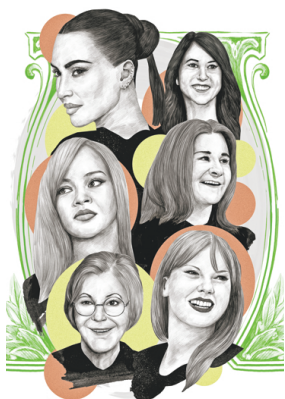
LONDON—In 2001, Prince Andrew retired from active duty in the Royal Navy, with a reputation as a war hero and something of a playboy. To keep the man eighth-in-line to the British throne gainfully employed, the U.K. government gave him a new job: special representative for international trade and investment.

By Max Colchester, Margot Patrick and David Luhnow

In the ensuing decade, files released by U.S. authorities indicate he shared confidential government reports with convicted sex offender Jeffrey Epstein. It was that, not allegations of sexual misconduct linked to his friendship with Epstein, that appear to be behind Andrew's arrest this week on suspicion of misconduct in public office. Andrew, stripped of his royal titles late last year, was released, while police said they would continue the investigation. A picture of a shell-shocked-looking Andrew after *Please turn to page A6*

◆ How investigators are looking at Epstein files... **A6**

EXCHANGE



THE GROWING LIST
The 154 women in the U.S. worth billions. **B1**

Economic Growth Slowed, Ending 2025 on Weak Note

By HARRIET TORRY

U.S. economic growth slowed sharply at the end of last year, weighed down by a record-long government shutdown and cooler consumer spending. U.S. gross domestic product—the value of all goods and services produced across the economy—rose at a 1.4% seasonally and inflation adjusted annual rate in the final quarter of last year, the Commerce Department said Friday. That was much weaker

than the 2.5% reading economists surveyed by The Wall Street Journal expected, and marked a sharp slowdown from the third-quarter's blistering 4.4% rate. The latest reading capped a year of slightly slower growth overall: In 2025, the economy expanded 2.2%, measured from the fourth quarter of the prior year, down from 2.4% in 2024 and the weakest pace since 2022. Economists also measure the year in another way—

comparing the nation's total output for 2025 with the prior year—to get a look at broader trends. According to that measure, the economy grew 2.2% last year, down from 2.8% in 2024 and the slowest pace since the economy last contracted in 2020. Even so, this growth re-

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◆ Inflation shows signs of heating up..... **A2**

◆ Consumers' mood brightens, survey finds..... **A2**

For Two Weeks, Wisconsinites Try to Spear a 200-Pound Fish

Locals huddle in ice-fishing huts and wait for the haul of a lifetime

By JOE BARRETT

OSHKOSH, Wis.—Peter and Lisa Smith sit inside a fishing shanty on the frozen waters of Lake Winnebago and stare for hours into the murky depths. For almost two decades, the couple have set out to spear sturgeon, the biggest—and perhaps most fiercely protected—fish in the Great Lakes. Lisa has caught just one. Peter has yet to do it. But the retirees, both 63, aren't giving up. "It's something to do in Wisconsin in February," Peter

said, leaning on a rail in the cozy cabin, the water glowing green, a radio playing softly and a space heater keeping the couple toasty. Thanks to a conservation program that started early in the last century, sturgeon are thriving here. The toothless bottom-feeder, which looks like a prehistoric catfish and can weigh over 200 pounds, has been overfished globally. Its coveted eggs can be processed into caviar. But in Wisconsin, no part of a wild *Please turn to page A10*

China's Xi Purges His 'Big Brother'

Shock arrest consolidates one-man rule

By LINGLING WEI

It was a bitterly cold, overcast winter day when China's senior-most general left for a meeting with hundreds of high-ranking Communist Party officials, including their leader, Xi Jinping. Gen. Zhang Youxia never made it. Security personnel sent by Xi intercepted Zhang en route to the gathering at the Central Party School in Beijing, said people close to

Chinese government decision-making. Securing the general in an undisclosed location, officers also raided Zhang's home and detained his son, a military researcher, the people said. Zhang's arrest on Jan. 19 marked a stunning fall for a man whose political lineage and loyalty once made him the bedrock of the Chinese ruler's military flank. But it also represented something more profound for China—the consolidation of absolute *Please turn to page A10*

